THE CLARITY DIAGNOSTIC

Five Stars That Nobody Sees

5 findings. The fixes. In order of impact.

Groove Dental — Glenora | Edmonton, AB

Prepared by Trent Wehrhahn · H-Cube Marketing · April 2026

I spent some time with Groove Dental's digital footprint this week. Here's what stood out.

Groove Dental has something most Edmonton practices don't: a legitimate reason for a patient to stay. Solo-dentist continuity. Advanced technology — 3D digital scanner, electric drills, in-house 3D X-ray — that most practices can't claim. And a 5.0-star average across every review the practice has ever received. That is real, and it matters.

> *Five stars across every review the practice has ever received. That is not a luck number. That is a quality signal.*

The problem is that almost none of it is visible to a patient searching in Edmonton. Groove Dental does not appear in the top 3 on any of the five highest-value local Maps searches — not for "Edmonton dentist," not for "family dentist," not for cosmetic, implants, or Invisalign. The practice is effectively invisible to the majority of local patients who would be a strong fit.

44

TOTAL GOOGLE REVIEWS

Against a 250+ standard for a newer practice. Gallery Dental, the category leader in Edmonton, has crossed 1,400.

On the five highest-value local Maps searches — Edmonton dentist, family dentist, cosmetic, implants, Invisalign — Groove Dental appears in zero of them.

The reason for that invisibility is not the quality of care. It is the absence of a system that converts patient satisfaction into digital proof. Forty-four reviews, at 5.0 stars, across a full practice operating history tells me two things simultaneously: patients are genuinely happy when they leave, and nobody has ever asked them to say so online. That gap is the diagnostic.

The fixes exist, they are sequenced below, and none of them require a significant budget. Most require 30 minutes to a few hours of setup and a change in habit. The hard part is not the fix — it is recognizing that the work happening inside the clinic has been invisible to the city searching for exactly what this practice offers.

How I See This

There is a specific type of marketing problem that does not announce itself loudly. The practice is busy enough. The existing patients are loyal. The clinical quality is high. From the inside, things feel fine. The problem is invisible — it lives in the patients who searched for a dentist in Edmonton, found Gallery Dental with 1,400 reviews and a dominant Maps presence, and never encountered Groove Dental at all.

That is what is happening here. Groove Dental is not losing patients it has. It is losing patients it never gets a chance to meet.

> *Groove Dental is not losing patients it has. It is losing patients it never gets a chance to meet.*

The root of this is a review pipeline that does not exist. Forty-four reviews at 5.0 is not a bad reputation — it is the residue of years of satisfied patients who were never prompted to say anything publicly. In Edmonton's dental market, where the dominant players are pushing 1,400+ reviews and seven-location groups are saturating local search, 44 reviews is not a starting point that Maps can work with. The algorithm surfaces practices with review velocity — consistent, recent, high-volume signals that tell Google this location is active and trusted. At under two reviews per month, Groove Dental is whispering in a conversation where the competitors are speaking at full volume.

The secondary layer of this problem is that the GBP listing is generic where it should be specific. The practice offers Invisalign, cosmetic dentistry, and dental implants — exactly the service searches that drive high-value new patients. But if the GBP categories don't declare those services, the Maps algorithm has no reason to surface the listing when patients search for them. Category optimization is a 45-minute fix. It should have been done the first month the practice opened.

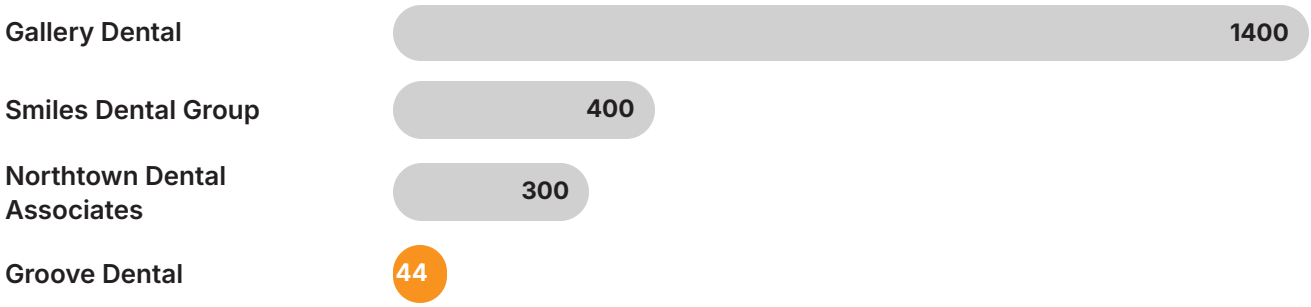
> The advanced technology — 3D scanner, electric drills, digital X-ray — is exactly the kind of differentiation that prospective patients respond to. None of it appears in the GBP listing, the Instagram profile, or the blog (which has not published since 2018). The patient who would care most about this never finds out.

The operating hours add a smaller but real conversion friction. Wednesday is closed. Tuesday, Thursday, and Friday close at 4pm. The only evening window is Monday. A working adult searching for a dentist on a Tuesday at 5pm has no way to book Groove Dental until Monday of the following week — and the appointments page is a contact form, not a real-time scheduler, so even submitting online puts them in a callback queue with no guaranteed response time. The Monday evening hours are a differentiator that most practices can't match. But a differentiator that requires a callback to activate doesn't fully convert.

Groove Dental is doing the hard part — the actual clinical work — at a genuinely high level. The marketing side of this practice is operating as if the quality speaks for itself. In a city where Gallery Dental has built a 1,400-review digital authority, it does not.

1 The Review Pipeline Is Missing — and It's the Root of Everything

I ran the five standard Maps searches for Edmonton: dentist, family dentist, cosmetic dentist, dental implants, Invisalign. Groove Dental does not appear in the top 3 on any of them. The practices that do — Gallery Dental, Northtown Dental Associates, Smiles Dental Group, Laurel Dental, Azarko Dental — share one thing: significantly larger Google review volumes. The Maps algorithm is not indifferent to review velocity. It uses it as a primary ranking signal.



Edmonton dentist Maps pack — Google review volume by practice

WHY THIS MATTERS

The Maps pack is where most new patient searches end. A patient on mobile searching "Edmonton dentist" sees three results before deciding whether to scroll further — and most don't scroll. Being absent from those three positions is not a nuisance. It is the difference between being found and not being found at all.

0 of 5

MAPS SEARCHES WHERE GROOVE DENTAL APPEARS IN TOP 3

Invisalign, implants, cosmetic, family, general — none.

The 5.0-star average is not the problem. If anything, it makes the situation more fixable — there is no reputation management issue to work around. The only issue is volume. And volume is a pipeline problem, not a quality problem.

Groove Dental: <2 reviews/month	8–15 reviews/month
DATA	INDUSTRY STANDARD

Monthly review velocity: Groove Dental vs. healthy single-location practice standard

HERE'S WHAT I'D DO

The fix has two stages.

Stage 1 — Install the pipeline (Week 1): Set up an automated review request that sends to every patient within 24–48 hours of their visit. The simplest version uses a direct Google review link sent via SMS or email. Most practice management platforms (including Jane App and Dentrix) support this natively or via a lightweight integration. If the current system doesn't support it, NiceJob or Google's own request link tool gets the job done in under an hour of setup. The message should be short, human, and signed from Dr. Schmidt personally. "I genuinely enjoyed seeing you — if you have a moment to leave a review, it helps more than you know." That tone, at a 5.0 practice, will convert.

Stage 2 — Monitor and adjust (Ongoing): Track the monthly review count. The target is 8–15 new reviews per month within 6 months of launch. At that velocity, the Maps ranking begins moving. At 12 months, the practice should be approaching 150–175 cumulative reviews — still below the 250+ standard, but in a range where Maps pack eligibility begins to open up.

Effort: Quick win (setup takes 1–2 hours; results compound over months)

2 The GBP Is Generic Where It Should Be Specific

Groove Dental offers Invisalign, cosmetic dentistry, dental implants, root canals, and dentures. These are confirmed by the practice's own service pages. The GBP is listed under "Family and Cosmetic Dentistry" — a broad descriptor with no service-specific categories. When a patient searches "Edmonton dental implants" or "Edmonton Invisalign," the Maps algorithm looks for GBP listings that have explicitly declared those services as categories. If the listing does not declare them, it does not rank for them.

> *The practice offers implants and Invisalign. The GBP does not say so. That is not a design choice — it is an oversight with a measurable cost.*

WHY THIS MATTERS

3–4

HIGH-MARGIN SERVICE CATEGORIES MISSING FROM GBP

Cosmetic Dentist, Dental Implants, Invisalign Provider, Emergency Dentist — each representing a distinct patient search intent

Service-specific Maps searches drive the highest-value new patients. A patient searching "Edmonton dental implants" is typically further in the decision cycle than a patient searching "Edmonton dentist." They have already decided to get implants — they are now choosing where. A GBP that doesn't declare implants as a service won't surface for that search. This is not an algorithm nuance. It is how Google Maps indexing works, and it is a 45-minute fix.

Beyond categories, the GBP needs a keyword-rich description, a photo library of at least 75 owner-uploaded images, and active monthly posts. None of these were visible from the public listing. Each one is an independent signal Google uses to evaluate listing quality.

HERE'S WHAT I'D DO

GBP categories (30 minutes): Log into Google Business Profile. Under "Edit Profile → Business category," add secondary categories: Cosmetic Dentist, Dental Implants Provider, and Emergency Dentist at minimum. If offering Invisalign, add "Orthodontist" or confirm Invisalign-specific category availability. Each added category expands the searches the listing is eligible to rank for.

GBP description (45 minutes): Write a 700–750 character description that uses natural language to name the services, the neighborhood, and the practice's differentiators. Example structure: "Groove Dental is a general and cosmetic dental practice in Glenora, Edmonton. Dr. Andrew Schmidt provides [list of services] using advanced technology including [3D scanner, electric drills, digital X-ray]. Now accepting new patients." Include the word "Edmonton" and the service names — those are the terms patients search.

Photos (2 hours initial, 10 minutes monthly): Upload 30–40 images to start: exterior, reception area, operatories, team photos, equipment photos (the 3D scanner especially — that is a differentiator worth showing). Aim for 75 total over 6–8 weeks. After that, add 3–5 photos monthly.

GBP posts (30 minutes monthly): One post per month minimum. This can be a patient education tip, a seasonal promotion, or a service spotlight. The goal is recency signal — Google favors active listings.

Effort: Quick win

3 The Appointment Page Is a Contact Form — Not Real-Time Booking

The appointment page at groovedental.ca/dental-appointments is a contact form. A patient who wants to book submits their name and reason for visit and waits for the practice to call back. There is no self-scheduling. No calendar. No confirmation. Just a form going into a queue.

> *A patient who submits a form at 6pm on a Tuesday and doesn't hear back by Wednesday noon has likely already scheduled somewhere else.*

WHY THIS MATTERS

3

WEEKDAYS CLOSING BEFORE 5PM (TUE, THU, FRI)

Patients searching after work have a single evening window — Monday — to reach this practice by phone

Wednesday is closed. Tuesday, Thursday, and Friday close at 4pm. A working adult who decides on a Tuesday evening to find a new dentist cannot call Groove Dental until Thursday morning — and cannot call on Wednesday at all. That patient has submitted a form into a queue with no guaranteed response time. At Gallery Dental or Smiles Dental Group, that same patient can self-schedule in under two minutes at 10pm on a Tuesday.

The Monday evening hours are genuinely valuable — 11am–7pm is a meaningful differentiator. But a differentiator that requires a callback to activate isn't fully converting its potential.

HERE'S WHAT I'D DO

Install real-time booking (1 week): Jane App, NexHealth, or Weave integrate with most Canadian practice management platforms and provide real-time patient-facing scheduling. The investment is typically $150–$300/month and pays for itself with a single additional new patient per month. Embed the booking widget on the homepage, the appointments page, and the contact page. Make it the primary CTA.

Promote the Monday evening hours explicitly: The 7pm close on Monday is a differentiator most Edmonton practices can't match. It should appear on the homepage ("Open Monday evenings until 7pm"), on the GBP listing, and in any social content. Patients looking for after-work availability are searching for exactly this — but they have to be able to find it.

Effort: Medium (real-time booking integration requires tool selection, setup, and website embedding — roughly one focused afternoon)

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4 The GBP and Website Are Hiding the Best Thing About This Practice

Groove Dental uses a 3D digital scanner instead of traditional impressions. Quiet electric handpieces instead of loud air-powered drills. An in-house 3D digital X-ray unit that most practices send out for. These are not standard. Patients with dental anxiety — a significant share of any dentist's market — will specifically seek out a practice that uses quiet equipment. Patients with a history of hating impressions will book a practice that eliminates them. These are conversion differentiators, not just clinical features.

> *The 3D scanner and quiet electric drills are exactly the kind of thing that turns a hesitant patient into a booked appointment. They are buried on an About page.*

WHY THIS MATTERS

40%

ALBERTA ADULTS WHO PUT OFF DENTAL WORK BECAUSE OF ANXIETY

H-Cube Marketing survey, n=1,000 — local data, not an estimate

A patient with dental anxiety searching for a new dentist in Edmonton is not reading About pages. They are scanning headlines, looking at photos, reading reviews for specific mentions of comfort and pain. If the GBP photos don't show the equipment. If the Instagram doesn't post about the no-impression experience. If the homepage headline doesn't mention quiet technology. That patient books somewhere else — not because Groove Dental isn't the right choice, but because the information that would make it the obvious choice wasn't visible.

HERE'S WHAT I'D DO

Make the technology visible on the homepage: Add a section above the fold or in the first scroll: "No traditional impressions. No loud drills. Advanced technology, designed for comfort." Short, clear, patient-facing. Link to a service page that explains each technology in plain language.

Create dedicated social content around the technology: A 3D scanner video (30 seconds of showing how it works) outperforms most dental social content because it is genuinely interesting to someone who has never seen one. Instagram Reels or a short Facebook video of "how we do impressions without impressions" is a low-effort, high-interest piece of content.

Feature the technology in the GBP description and photo library: The 3D scanner is a visual asset. A photo of the scanner with a caption "digital impressions — no trays, no mess" belongs in the GBP photo library. The GBP description should mention the technology explicitly.

Effort: Quick win (copy changes to homepage and GBP take 1–2 hours; social content creation requires one shoot session)

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5 Seven Years Without a Blog Post Is a Signal the Algorithm Reads

The blog at groovedental.ca/blog/ last published in April 2018. That is over seven years of silence from a content channel that Google uses to evaluate whether a website is actively maintained and worth surfacing in organic search results. The practice has service pages, but static service pages without fresh content do not accumulate the kind of topical authority that drives organic search rankings. The blog dormancy is not the most urgent fix in this audit — but it is a slow compound cost that becomes harder to recover from the longer it runs.

> *A blog that last published in 2018 is not just outdated. It is a signal Google reads. It says: nobody is home.*

WHY THIS MATTERS

7+ years

TIME SINCE LAST BLOG POST ON GROOVEDENTAL.CA

Google's crawl frequency for low-activity sites declines over time, further suppressing indexing of any new content when it does appear

Organic search is a second visibility channel alongside Maps. For Groove Dental, ranking in Maps is the priority — but a content engine also builds trust with prospective patients before they call, gives social

media something to post, and supports GBP post content. A practice that publishes 2–3 patient education posts per month demonstrates active expertise in a way that static service pages cannot.

The Instagram and Facebook accounts compound this finding. Instagram has 37 total posts and 366 followers. Facebook has 134 likes. These numbers indicate that social has never been treated as a growth channel — they have been maintained at a maintenance level that produces no meaningful audience.

HERE'S WHAT I'D DO

Restart the blog at a sustainable cadence: Two posts per month is manageable and meaningful. Topics that perform: "What to expect from your first visit at Groove Dental," "Why we use a 3D scanner instead of impressions," "What Edmonton patients should know about Invisalign costs," "Signs you might need a dental implant — and what the process looks like." These are patient questions — not marketing content — and they rank.

Connect the blog to social and GBP: Each new blog post becomes a GBP post, an Instagram caption, and a Facebook post. One piece of content, three distribution channels. This is not a major time investment once the habit is established.

Instagram: commit to a minimum cadence: Three posts per week on Instagram, mixing educational tips, before/after cases (with patient consent), technology features, and team moments. The goal in year one is not to go viral — it is to show prospective patients that the practice is active, modern, and worth following.

Effort: Medium (requires a content calendar, a writing or editing workflow, and a consistent scheduling habit — not a one-time fix, but manageable with a clear system)

Other Things I Noticed

The Monday evening hours are an underused differentiator. Very few Edmonton practices are open until 7pm on a Monday. This is a direct response to working adults who cannot take time off for dental appointments. It deserves to be prominently featured on the website homepage, the GBP listing under hours, and in social content. "Late Monday appointments available — no time off work needed" is a headline worth testing.

The practice name and location story have character. Glenora is a specific, appealing neighborhood — "just outside downtown, without the downtown commute." That positioning line is already on the website and it is good. It should appear in the GBP description and social bio.

Solo-dentist continuity is a genuine patient anxiety point. Many patients leave corporate dental chains specifically because they see a different dentist every visit. Dr. Schmidt's model — one dentist, every visit — is a differentiator for a specific patient type who values consistency. It should be positioned explicitly as a feature, not just mentioned incidentally.

The review responses, if they exist, should be personalized. With 44 reviews at 5.0, any response practice that is currently in place is worth auditing. Each response to a Google review is indexed by Google and signals that the practice is actively engaged. Personalized responses (not copy-paste templates) strengthen the trust signal for patients reading reviews before they call.

The practice website has good bones. Service-specific pages (family dentist, cosmetic dentistry, root canals, dental check-ups, dentures, implants) are present and named correctly. These are the right pages to have. They need updated copy that connects to patient outcomes, not just service descriptions, and they benefit from the blog and social content directed toward them.

The Yelp listing appears active. A Yelp entry was visible in search results (Updated December 2025), which suggests the practice has some third-party listing presence beyond Google. Keeping that listing consistent and complete is worth a 15-minute review.

How I'd Sequence the Fixes

This week

- Set up automated post-visit review request via SMS or email (1–2 hours)
- Update GBP categories to include Cosmetic Dentist, Dental Implants Provider, Emergency Dentist (30 minutes)
- Write and publish a keyword-rich GBP description (45 minutes)
- Select a real-time booking tool (Jane App, NexHealth, or Weave) and begin setup

Next 30 days

- Upload 30–40 photos to GBP: exterior, interior, equipment (the 3D scanner especially), team
- Complete real-time booking integration and embed widget on homepage, appointments page, and contact page
- Add Monday evening hours and booking CTA to homepage prominently
- Publish first GBP post (service spotlight or patient education tip)
- Add technology differentiators (3D scanner, electric drills, digital X-ray) to homepage copy and GBP description
- Establish a social content cadence on Instagram — 3 posts per week minimum

30–90 days

- Publish 2 blog posts per month, starting with technology and new patient experience topics
- Cross-post each blog post to Instagram, Facebook, and GBP
- Review and respond personally to every incoming Google review
- Monitor monthly review count — target 8+ new reviews per month by month 3
- Audit homepage mobile experience on a real device; check LCP via PageSpeed Insights

Ongoing

- Monthly GBP post
- Bi-weekly blog content (2 posts/month)
- Weekly Instagram posts (3x/week)
- Review velocity tracking — monthly count, cumulative total, Maps position tracking for 5 target searches
- Quarterly GBP photo refresh (5–10 new images)
- Review all incoming reviews within 48 hours and respond personally

The Next Step

> *Everything in this audit is yours to implement. The fixes are spelled out, in order of impact. Most practices won't get to them — not because they don't matter, but because there's never time.*
>
> *If you want to go deeper, the full Clarity Audit is the next step — using your internal numbers and systems to build a 90-day plan tailored to your specific revenue goals, patient mix, and team capacity. It starts with a short intake form so I arrive prepared.*
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